楼上的音乐

天天晚上七点，楼上有人唱歌

Music from Upstairs

Every evening at seven, someone upstairs is singing

Text and translation by Claude (Anthropic)

Footnotes mark names and words above HSK 2 (HSK 3.0 lists: github.com/ivankra/hsk30, MIT).

1 陈静†是大学生，今年二十岁。一个月以前，她在学校旁边租了一个小房间，在五楼。房间虽然很小，但是很干净，离学校也很近，她很喜欢。再过一个月就要考试了，她想天天在房间里好好儿复习。

天天晚上

2 可是住进来的第一天晚上，七点刚到，楼上就有了音乐。音乐的声音很大，还有很多人在唱歌，唱得很高兴。陈静想："没关系，一会儿就好了。"她等了一个小时，到了八点，音乐才停。

3 第二天晚上七点，楼上的音乐又来了。第三天也一样，第四天也一样。陈静看着书，可是一个字也没看懂，她的头很疼。她想："楼上一定住着一个年轻人，他天天晚上跟朋友们开晚会。他不用学习，也不用工作吗？"

† 陈静 *Chén Jìng* Chen Jing (a student)

Chen Jing is a university student. She is twenty this year. A month ago, she 1
rented a small room next to her university, on the fifth floor. The room was small, but it was very clean and close to the university, and she liked it a lot. In another month she would have exams, and she wanted to study hard in her room every day.

Every Evening

But on the very first evening after she moved in, just as it turned seven, mu- 2
sic started upstairs. The music was very loud, and lots of people were singing along, singing happily. Chen Jing thought, "Never mind, it will be over soon." She waited an hour. Only at eight o'clock did the music stop.

The next evening at seven, the music came again. The third day was the 3
same, and the fourth too. Chen Jing stared at her books but didn't take in a single word, and her head ached. She thought, "A young man must live upstairs, and he has a party with his friends every night. Doesn't he have to study, or work?"

3 她以为楼上的人一点儿也不关心别人，心里越来越生气。

4 晚上，陈静†给妈妈打电话："妈，楼上的人天天晚上开晚会，我没办法复习。"妈妈说："你去楼上跟他好好儿说说吧。""我不想去。这样的人，跟他说了也没有用。"妈妈笑了："你还没见过他，怎么知道他是什么样的人？"陈静没说话。她想："妈妈说得也对。"

我要去楼上

5 星期五晚上七点，楼上又唱起来了。陈静站起来，说："我要去楼上！我要告诉他，这儿不是他一个人的家！"她走到六楼，站在门口。门里的音乐很大，她在门口大声问："有人吗？"

6 门开了。开门的不是年轻人，是一个老人。

† 陈静 *Chén Jìng* Chen Jing (a student)

She thought the person upstairs didn't care about anyone else at all, and she grew angrier and angrier. 3

That night, Chen Jing called her mother. "Mum, the person upstairs has a party every night, and I can't study." Her mother said, "Go upstairs and have a proper talk with him." "I don't want to. With someone like that, talking won't do any good." Her mother laughed. "You haven't even met him. How do you know what kind of person he is?" Chen Jing said nothing. She thought, "Mum has a point." 4

I'm Going Upstairs

On Friday evening at seven, the singing upstairs started again. Chen Jing stood up and said, "I'm going upstairs! I'm going to tell him this isn't just his own home!" She walked up to the sixth floor and stood at the door. The music behind the door was loud. She called out at the door, "Is anybody there?" 5

The door opened. The person who opened it was not a young man but an old man. 6

6 他的头发都白了，他笑着问："你好！你是哪个孩子的妈妈？"原来，老人以为她是来接孩子的妈妈。陈静†不知道说什么好。她看见房间里坐着八个孩子，大的十岁，小的六七岁，他们都拿着歌本。原来唱歌的不是年轻人，是孩子们！

原来是他

7 老人请陈静进去坐，说："我姓李‡，你叫我李爷爷吧。"李爷爷以前是中学的音乐老师，今年七十岁了。楼里有很多孩子，他们的爸爸妈妈下班很晚，孩子们放学以后没有地方去。所以李爷爷天天晚上教他们唱歌，不要钱。他说："孩子们虽然唱得不太好，但是都很喜欢唱。"

8 陈静说："李爷爷，对不起。我以为楼上住着一个天天开晚会的年轻人，我还想来跟他说说呢。"

† 陈静 *Chén Jìng* Chen Jing (a student)　　‡ 李 *Lǐ* Li (surname)

His hair was completely white. He smiled and asked, "Hello! Which child's 6
mother are you?" It turned out the old man thought she was a mother who had come to pick up her child. Chen Jing didn't know what to say. She saw eight children sitting in the room. The oldest was ten, the youngest six or seven, and they were all holding songbooks. So the singers weren't young men at all. They were children!

So It Was Him

The old man invited Chen Jing in to sit down and said, "My surname is 7
Li. Call me Grandpa Li." Grandpa Li used to be a music teacher at a middle school, and he is seventy this year. There are lots of children in the building. Their parents finish work late, so after school the children have nowhere to go. So Grandpa Li teaches them to sing every evening, without asking for money. He said, "The children don't sing very well, but they all love singing."

Chen Jing said, "I'm sorry, Grandpa Li. I thought a young man who had 8
parties every night lived upstairs, and I came up to have a word with him."

8 李[†]爷爷笑了：“是我们不好，我们的声音太大了，你在楼下一定没办法学习。”他想了想，又说：“以后我们七点半就停，声音也小一点儿，好吗？”

9 这时候，一个小女孩问陈静[‡]：“姐姐，你会唱歌吗？”陈静笑了：“会一点儿。”她唱了几句，孩子们都说：“姐姐唱得真好听！”李爷爷也说：“原来你也会唱歌！你唱得比我好。星期天下午，你来跟我们一起唱，好吗？”虽然再过几个星期就要考试了，但是陈静还是说：“好！”

10 现在，天天晚上七点，楼上还是有音乐，可是陈静不生气了。她一边复习，一边听孩子们唱歌，有时候还小声跟着唱。星期天下午，她就去楼上，跟李爷爷和孩子们一起唱歌。孩子们都叫她“小陈[§]老师”。那次考试，她考得很好。

† 李 *Lǐ* Li (surname)
‡ 陈静 *Chén Jìng* Chen Jing (a student)
§ 陈 *Chén* Chen (surname)

Grandpa Li laughed. "It's our fault. We were too loud. You must not have been able to study down there." He thought for a moment and said, "From now on we'll stop at half past seven, and we'll be a bit quieter. All right?" 8

Just then, a little girl asked Chen Jing, "Big sister, can you sing?" Chen Jing smiled. "A little." She sang a few lines, and all the children said, "Big sister sings really beautifully!" Grandpa Li said too, "So you can sing as well! You sing better than I do. Will you come and sing with us on Sunday afternoons?" Although her exams were only a few weeks away, Chen Jing still said, "Yes!" 9

Now, every evening at seven, there is still music upstairs, but Chen Jing isn't angry any more. She studies while she listens to the children singing, and sometimes she even sings along quietly. On Sunday afternoons she goes upstairs and sings with Grandpa Li and the children. The children all call her "Little Teacher Chen." And in those exams, she did very well. 10